Explaining the Effect of Physical Activity on Heart Rate

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Explaining the Effect of Physical Activity on Heart Rate: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Heart rate increases during exercise to increase blood flow to the working muscles
- This is important for several reasons:
  - To provide them with enough **nutrients and oxygen** for **increased respiration**
  - To **remove waste products at a faster rate**
- Following exercise, the heart continues to beat faster for a while
  - to ensure that **all excess waste products are removed** from muscle cells
  - to deliver extra oxygen to the muscle cells to pay off the oxygen debt accumulated when oxygen levels are not high enough to support aerobic respiration
    - The extra oxygen is used to break down the **lactic acid** that has been built up in cells as a result of anaerobic respiration

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